

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

give a common example, if you take a career break or reduce your working hours in order to fulfil a caring role – most typically after having a child – you might want to have a serious conversation about your working (or full-time working) partner contributing to your pension. It is a huge risk for women to rely on their partner's pension while caring their way into a precarious, under-pensioned position, and this risk undermines your future financial wellbeing. Of course, we all want to believe that our relationship will last for ever – and maybe it will – but similarly to having an emergency fund, knowing that your pension is going to be *enough* no matter what happens in your relationship is a much-needed comfort. There is no reason why a couple's decision to have a child should jeopardize the mother's (or, on rare occasions, the father's) pension only.

So, you see, pensions are really not just about having enough money to go to bingo. When you retire, you are still going to want to enjoy life as much as you do now, and to make the most of the extra time that you have after working for decades. Investing the time, effort and money needed to build up a good pension will be so worth your efforts, even if it's just a brief check every few months, an extra glance at your employment contract and an extra percentage point of your salary each time you get a pay rise. These small moves, made early enough, will help you to secure your financial wellbeing for the future, which will also help you to feel more confident and in control of your money in the present.